retirement, the company had registered an all-time record figure of ₹48 crores for new business.

With Purshotamdas's involvement in nearly every important economic issue of the day, it is not surprising that he was also actively involved in the planning process. The basis for future planning was laid by the appointment of the National Planning Committee in 1938 and later in 1944 by the publication of the plan popularly called the Bombay Plan by a group of prominent Indian industrialists. Purshotamdas was closely associated with both these efforts.

In 1939, Purshotamdas came into official contact with C.D. Deshmukh of the ICS, who ultimately became the first Indian Governor of the RBI. Purshotamdas (along with B.M. Birla) played a major role in Deshmukh's elevation to this august post. He lobbied, canvassed, coaxed, and cajoled to ensure that Deshmukh and not another expatriate got the top job at the RBI. Later, he was a valued adviser to Deshmukh and his successors as he had been to Sir Osborne Smith and Sir James Taylor, Deshmukh's predecessors.



Sir Chintaman Dwarkanath Deshmukh[7], the man whose ascension to the RBI's Governorship was facilitated by Purshotamdas, had a career which is perhaps without equal in modern India, and must have few parallels elsewhere in the world. Civil servant, central banker, Union Finance Minister, educationist, institution builder, and social worker, Deshmukh occupied an amazing variety of offices and left an indelible mark on numerous institutions in India. The only office that he aspired to, but which did not receive him, was that of the President of India.

Deshmukh called his memoirs *The Course of My Life*, inviting comparisons between a river and his life. That river originated in the Western Ghats, but unlike a normal river, followed a course unprecedented in geography by flowing upward all the time, for the trajectory of his outstanding career knew only one direction, and that was up.

Deshmukh was born on January 14, 1896, at Nata village in the Mahad taluka of Maharashtra's Kolaba district. It was the auspicious day of Makar Sankrant and Deshmukh's life and career certainly confirmed the propitious nature of the day. He was the eldest child of Dwarkanath, who practiced law